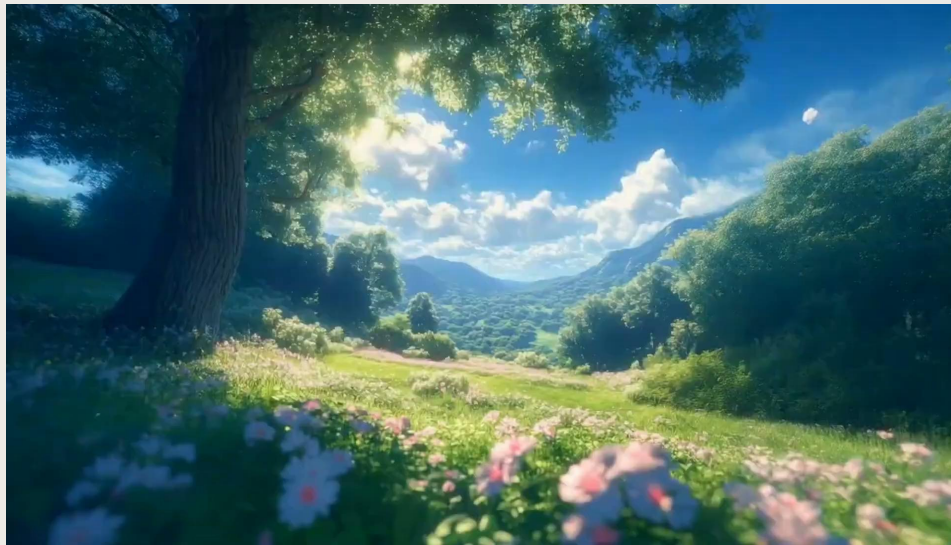


A BRIEFING — PENTAGON DEALS, 2026

On quiet ground, a fracture.

*A field, untouched. A policy, undone. The story of
the year frontier AI met the United States military.*



CHAPTER 01 — ABOUT

Anthropic & OpenAI, with the Pentagon.

*A small team, a contested year, and a question of
who sets the limits of military artificial intelligence.*

TEAM MEMBERS

01

Tony

Lead | Context | Design

02

*Adam*Sources, Analysis,
Graphic

03

*Derek*Sources Analysis,
Presentator

04

Steve

Ideas, Presentator

CHAPTER 02 — JULY 2025 → FEB 2026

The \$200M Ultimatum.

A federal frontier-AI contract, repurposed as a coercion lever.

Comply with the lift on safety guardrails or be revoked. The first overt test of whether vendor ethics or government authority defines the boundaries of military AI.

CONTRACT

\$200M
ORIGIN

ISSUED

Jul 2025

ULTIMATUM

Feb 2026

TIMELINE — FEB – MAY 2026

The principals.

-
- I. Demand*
Lift Anthropic's hard limits on autonomous lethality and mass surveillance.
 - II. Leverage*
\$200M federal pipeline conditioned on full compliance.
 - III. Reprisal*
Refusal triggers blacklist designation and contract revocation.

ANTHROPIC — PUBLIC USAGE POLICY

The Hard Limits.

I. No Autonomous Weapons

Claude cannot be deployed for fully autonomous lethal decisions. Human-in-the-loop, always.

II. No Mass Surveillance

Claude will not be turned on the population. No untargeted, large-scale surveillance — foreign or domestic.



CBS NEWS, EXCLUSIVE

“We cannot, in good conscience, comply.”— D. AMODEI

REFERENCES

Sources.

-
- 01 [CNN](#)
PENTAGON AI / ANTHROPIC, 2026
 - 02 [NPR](#)
TRUMP, ANTHROPIC, PENTAGON, OPENAI — AI WEAPONS BAN
 - 03 [Forbes](#)
OPENAI, NVIDIA, ALPHABET SIGN PENTAGON AI DEAL
 - 04 [NY Times](#)
PENTAGON AI COMPANIES DEALS, MAY 2026

LAWSUIT, CASE TRACKING

The Blacklist.

A federal designation: Supply Chain Risk. The court paused it. The underlying question remains live.

CASE NO.	VENUE
ND-Cal-2026-0317	U.S.D.C. N.D. Cal
FILED	RELIEF
March 2026	Prelim. Injunction
STATUS	JURISDICTION
Blacklist Paused	Federal, Art. III



SUBJECT — ANTHROPIC

PLATE 05 — BLOCKED FROM FEDERAL PIPELINES



The Defense Coalition.

PENTAGON BRIEFING — 01 MAY 2026

OpenAI

Frontier model access cleared for classified defense workflows under "all lawful use."

RESTRICTIONS LIFTED

Nvidia

Compute substrate. Classified-tier GPUs and inference infrastructure for the new model stack.

COMPUTE CLEARED

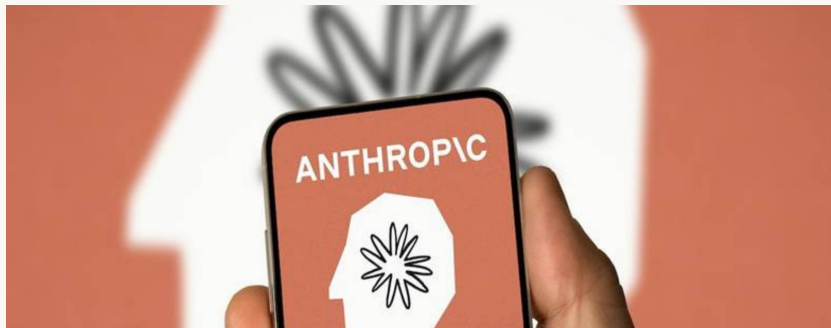
Alphabet

Gemini cleared for classified deployments. Quiet retirement of the 2018 Project Maven pledge.

PLEDGE RETIRED

TRACK A

Anthropic.



Holds the line on autonomous weapons and mass surveillance.

Sues the administration in N.D. Cal — wins preliminary injunction.

Trades the \$200M federal pipeline for its safety policy.

POSTURE

Constraint

OpenAI.



Accepts the “all lawful use” clause for classified workflows.

Joined by Nvidia (compute) and Alphabet (Gemini).

Inherits the federal pipeline Anthropic vacated.

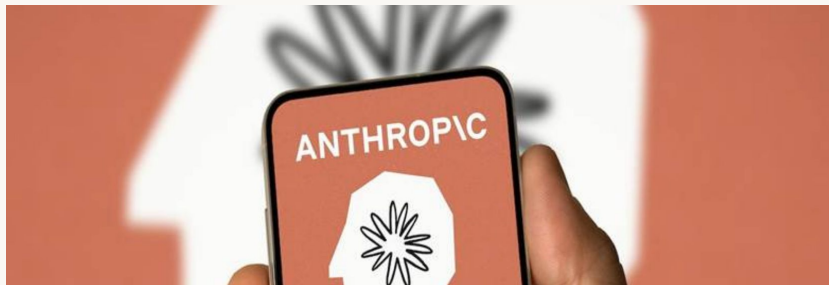
POSTURE

Compliance

Citizen vs. Government.

DIFF — GUARDRAILS

CITIZEN



“Safety & Privacy.”

Autonomous lethal decisions outpace existing oversight.

Mass surveillance tooling rarely stays pointed outward.

Vendor ‘hard limits’ were a check the public never voted on.

FRAME *Rights & Restraint*

GOVERNMENT



“All Lawful Use.”

National security cannot wait for vendor approval cycles.

Military authority — not a model card — defines lawful action.

Strategic parity with adversaries demands unrestricted tooling.

FRAME *Sovereignty & Speed*



CHAPTER 05 — DOCTRINE

The Hegseth Doctrine.

“Private companies should not set policy for military operations.”

— PETE HEGSETH, SEC. OF DEFENSE

I. Sovereignty

Lethal-use boundaries set by elected government, not vendor terms of service.

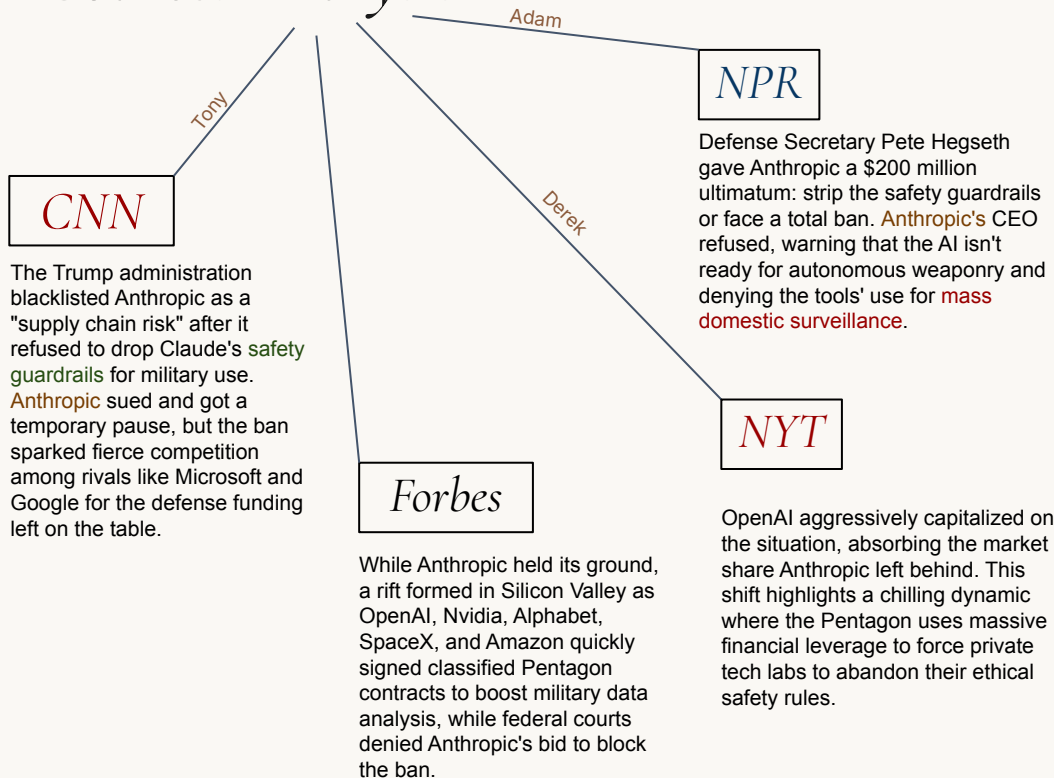
II. All Lawful Use

If legal under U.S. military authority, no model guardrail blocks it.

III. Vendor Substitution

Refusing labs are replaced. Strategic AI is fungible.

Sources Analysis



Forbes

The New York Times



Conclusion: Output Effects & Controversy

The Pentagon's aggressive push for unrestricted AI has completely changed the tech landscape. By sidelining Anthropic and teaming up with OpenAI and others, the military successfully bypassed safety guardrails, clearing the way for AI to be used in autonomous warfare and mass surveillance.

This has sparked a massive debate. On one side, the government argues that keeping these models restricted holds America back against foreign adversaries, insisting that private tech companies shouldn't be making national security decisions. On the other side, everyday citizens and human rights groups are deeply worried. They see this as a dangerous overreach, warning that removing these safeguards invites catastrophic automated errors, threatens civilian privacy, and sets a terrifying precedent where the government can pressure private companies into weaponizing their technology.

A BRIEF SIGN-OFF

Thank you.

*From a quiet field to a fractured doctrine — this was
the year the limits were re-drawn.*

TEAM DUCKIEZ · THE AI SCHISM, 2026